

WhatsApp-Led Local Service Discovery — Consolidated Summary (India)

1. Research Goals –

- Understand how people currently discover local services and what channels they use.
- Identify key pain points, trust gaps, and frustrations in existing discovery methods.
- Evaluate the role of trust, referrals, and community recommendations in decision-making.
- Assess the size of the opportunity and which user segments rely most on informal discovery.
- Determine feasibility, risks, and constraints of enabling structured service discovery through WhatsApp.

1.1 Key Interview Questions–

Can you tell me about where you live and whether you're part of any neighborhood or society WhatsApp groups?
Think about the last time you needed a service like a plumber, electrician, maid, or repair person. How did you find them?
Did WhatsApp play any role in helping you find that person? If yes, how?
What made you choose that person over other options?
What was the most frustrating or difficult part of finding that service provider?
Have you ever struggled to find a reliable service provider when you needed one urgently? What happened?
How much do you trust recommendations from WhatsApp groups compared to Google or apps like Urban Company? Why?
Have you ever had difficulty finding an old recommendation shared in WhatsApp? Can you tell me about that?
If finding trusted local service providers could be made easier, what would make the biggest difference for you?
Is there anything else about finding local services that you find annoying or difficult today?

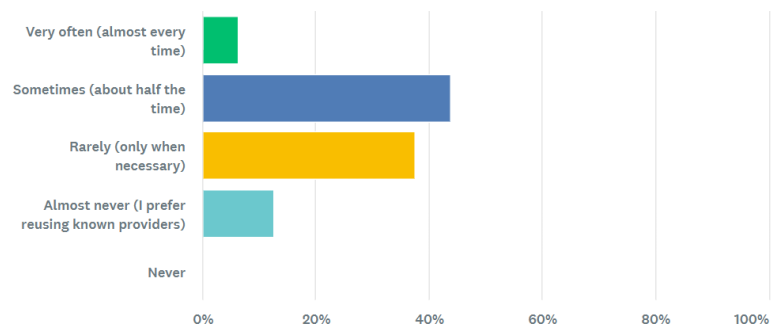
2. Top 10 most relevant insights-

#	Insight	Direct Quote
1	WhatsApp groups are already a primary discovery channel	"Last week itself need a plumber, posted in a society whatsapp group." — Rishab "Thankfully whatsapp group from friends, mygate helped find carpenter." — Aasheena
2	Trust is highest when recommendations come from known communities	"I would prefer whatsapp group recommendation more than apps." — Rishab "Trust neighbor more than apps." — Nitika "I trust if it's recommended by the group." — Pranati
3	Discovery is fragmented across multiple sources	"Contact admin or neighbor to get help." — Nitika "Ask security guard, building staff, or local contacts." — Survey
4	Response delays and effort are major pain points	"The time lag to get the information – contact details." — Rishab "Finding the right person urgently." — Shivi
5	Users prefer reusing known providers instead of discovering new ones	"Contact a service provider I've used before." — Survey "Almost never (I prefer reusing known providers)." — Survey
6	Users lose contact details and cannot retrieve trusted providers easily	"It's difficult to locate the details of old people who provided service." — Rishab "Always very difficult to navigate." — Pranati
7	Trust uncertainty is the biggest psychological barrier	"Trust factor for people that you don't know." — Pranati "Generally I only get contact number, that's it." — Rishab
8	Social validation matters more than price comparison	"Recommendation from someone is great." — Rishab "They would've previously used their services." — Pranati
9	Discovery responsibility is often centralized in one household member	"My father in law or husband takes care of it." — Pranati "Owner of the property gets all the services." — Shivi
10	Users clearly want a faster and easier discovery solution	"It will save a lot of time." — Nitika "Definitely, saves a lot of time." — Pranati "If there was a solution to find these details easily." — Aasheena



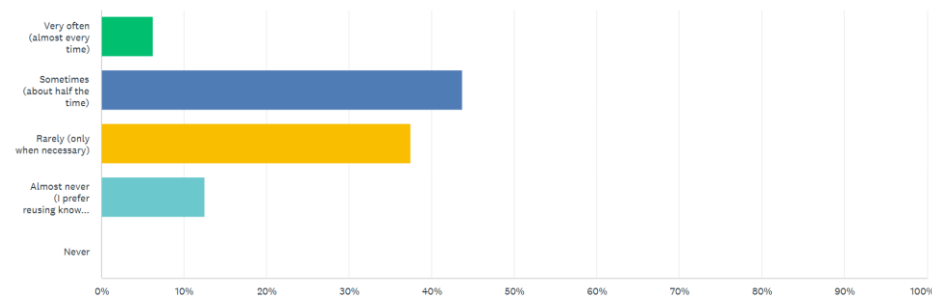
How often do you use NEW service providers (someone you have never used before)?

Answered: 16 Skipped: 0



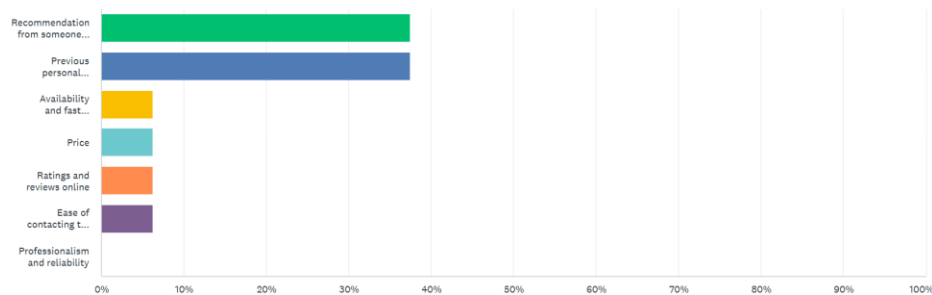
How often do you use NEW service providers (someone you have never used before)?

Answered: 16 Skipped: 0



Which factor is MOST important when choosing a local service provider?

Answered: 16 Skipped: 0



3. Strategy Implications for WhatsApp–

- WhatsApp should focus on strengthening **trusted discovery within existing groups**, since users already rely on them for recommendations.
- The key opportunity is to solve **retrieval and memory problems**. It help users easily find and reuse trusted service contacts shared in chats.
- WhatsApp should act as a **trust and discovery layer**, not a full-service marketplace, to avoid operational and legal complexity.
- Priority should be on improving **speed, convenience, and trust signals**, while preserving privacy and natural group behavior.
- The long-term strategy is to turn WhatsApp from an **unstructured conversation tool into a structured, trusted local knowledge network** without changing how users currently behave.

4. Potential, Research-Led Product Ideas–

- Option to tag Existing Whatsapp Groups or create new group as Society/Locality/RWA/DDA Colony (Housing Groups)
- If a group is already tagged as Housing group then have a option within the group known as services where a collection of all services operator numbers are saved under the service type tag with ratings provided by the sharer and users
- Tagging of contacts as unverified for shared but never used services contractors